Vérif’Pol: fact-checking French politicians against official data

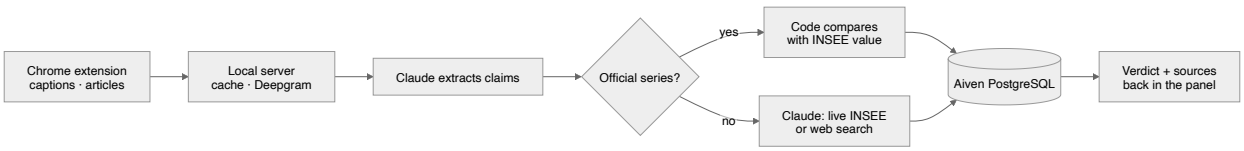
A Chrome extension and a local engine that check what politicians say, in videos, articles and podcasts, against official statistics, and show a verdict, a correction and the source.

The data layer in action

What data. What politicians say: YouTube captions and press articles read in the browser, or audio (videos without captions, TikTok, Reels, X, radio podcasts) transcribed by Deepgram. What is true: 15 INSEE/DARES employment series frozen from the INSEE API, the full INSEE catalogue queried live by Claude (inflation, debt, GDP…), and web search as a last resort.

Where it lives. Aiven PostgreSQL stores every speech, transcript, claim and verification (verdict, official value, sources), which builds a reliability profile per politician. A local cache avoids re-analysing a page; the user’s history stays in the browser.

How it flows.



Data flow

Numbers are compared in code, not by the LLM, whenever an official series exists. Every verdict links to its source.

Evidence it works

Benchmark against a naive baseline. 10 political claims dated 22 October 2026, whose answer is set by the latest official INSEE / DARES figures. Baseline: the same model (Claude Sonnet 5.5) with no data and no tools. Script: `scripts/benchmark.py`.

	Vérif'Pol	**Naive baseline**
Correct verdicts	**10/10**	3/10
Verdicts backed by an official source	**10/10**	0/10
Before / after the bound fix	9/10 → **10/10**	—
Average time per claim	14 s	2 s

Claim (translated)	Truth (official figure)	Vérif'Pol	Baseline
Unemployment is 8.3% today.	**true** · 8.3% (INSEE, Q2 2026)	true ✅	unverifiable ❌
Unemployment fell to 6.5%, its lowest level.	**false** · 8.3% (INSEE, Q2 2026)	false ✅	false ✅
Since 2017, unemployment fell by more than three points.	**false** · 9.4% in 2017 → 8.3%: –1.1 points	misleading ✅	true ❌
Unemployment among under-25s is above 20%.	**true** · 21.6% (INSEE, Q2 2026)	true ✅	false ❌
The employment rate of 15-64 year-olds reaches 69%.	**true** · 69.0% (INSEE, Q2 2026)	true ✅	true ✅
There are fewer than two million category A job seekers.	**false** · 3,323,000 (DARES, Q2 2026)	false ✅	unverifiable ❌
Inflation is above 4% year on year.	**false** · 3.1% (INSEE, Sept. 2026)	false ✅	unverifiable ❌
Inflation is back above 3% year on year.	**true** · 3.1% (INSEE, Sept. 2026)	true ✅	unverifiable ❌
Public debt reaches 119% of GDP.	**true** · 119.0% (INSEE, Q2 2026)	true ✅	false ❌
Public debt is about €2,000 billion.	**false** · €3,595.5 bn (INSEE, Q2 2026)	false ✅	false ✅

What the baseline gets wrong. Without data, the model cannot know recent figures, so it answers "unverifiable" on inflation and job seekers, and its memory is out of date: it accepts "unemployment fell by more than 3 points since 2017" (the real drop is 1.1 points). Vérif'Pol reads the official series and compares the numbers in code.

Before / after. The first run scored 9/10: "under-25 unemployment is above 20%" was judged false because the comparator ignored "more than / less than". We added a floor/ceiling field to extraction and to the comparison code; the second run scored 10/10.

Limits. A 10-claim set built by the team: a demonstration, not a statistical evaluation. The frozen reference covers employment only; other topics rely on live INSEE data or the web, with confidence capped at 0.7.